

The Build List

35 Requests for an Operations Intelligence Hub

One brain, not thirty apps. Every request below makes our people better at their jobs. None of them try to do their jobs. Grouped by the same seven themes as the challenge doc.

Theme 1: See It Coming

- Build a produce forecast off harvest calendars and our inbound history
- Score every donor and vendor on delivered versus committed
- Flag the right windows to buy purchased food before prices move
- Predict actual truck arrival times from carrier behavior, not the schedule
- Scan grant and funding streams and match them to our capital and program needs

Theme 2: The Warehouse That Explains Itself

- Put PO and DO data on the scanner at the truck, matched as product is scanned
- Recommend bin locations from velocity, weight, and pick frequency
- Sequence every pick list for the shortest walk through the building
- Flag produce condition and shelf life with a camera at receiving
- Warn us when product will expire before it moves at current velocity
- Predict forklift and dock equipment failures before they happen
- Point cycle counts at the bins most likely to have variances

Theme 3: Production Is Manufacturing

- Forecast boxes, bags, and kits to build, by program, weeks ahead
- Recommend line setup and crew size for what is actually being packed that day
- Predict volunteer turnout and flag no-show risk before the shift starts
- Generate tomorrow's raw material staging plan tonight, by station, in order
- Track yield on the line and flag runs producing more waste than they should

Theme 4: Equity With a Truck Attached

- Route on agency access windows and product urgency, not just miles
- Match EV charging schedules to tomorrow's routes and our daytime power cap
- Balance driver workload on stop difficulty, not stop count
- Rebuild the day in minutes when a truck goes down or an agency cancels
- Detect patterns in refused product and short receipts across agencies

Theme 5: Need Is the Demand Signal

- Flag when an agency's ordering drifts from what their neighborhood actually needs
- Replace pre-allocation with pull-based replenishment signals
- Warn us when access friction is building, before neighbors quietly stop coming
- Match inbound product to neighborhood preferences and dietary patterns
- Translate pantry hours, eligibility, and locations into plain language, in any language

Theme 6: Every Team Member an Analyst

- Answer a plain question from anyone on the team, no ticket, no SQL
- Brief every lead at shift start: inbound, at risk, what changed overnight
- Turn a voice note from the floor into a structured proposal
- Simulate receiving, picking, and agency scenarios so new staff practice before live product
- Capture long-tenured staff knowledge into searchable operating guidance

Theme 7: A Smarter Movement

- Benchmark receiving, picking, production, and routing across food banks on anonymized data
- Match one food bank's surplus to another's shortage before product ages out
- Model how a SNAP change or economic shift hits our service area, by neighborhood